

Future Insights: The Future Living Report 2021

In the second of three collaborative reports with Huckletree, we explore the UK's innovative Future Living industry.

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Future Insights: The Future Living Report 2021

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Equity investment trends over the past decade
Top investors backing Future Living companies
Emerging sectors and trends within this space
Industry deep-dives into HealthTech, EdTech and ParentTech

Here's a sneak-peak inside

Emerging sectors and trends

Companies operating in the Future Living high-growth landscape are certainly marked by cutting-edge innovation and being part of the newest emerging sectors. EdTech, referring to the convergence of education and technology to improve teaching and learning, is the top emerging sector group. Fast growth EdTech companies include Kano, which offers kits to teach children how to

make computers and learn to code, as well as Kortext, which provides an online learning platform with access to digital textbooks. Other top emerging sectors are eHealth and the Internet of Things. eHealth describes the use of information and communication technology relating to healthcare services and systems, from patient records to wearable medical devices. The Internet of Things covers

a broad range of physical devices connected to the internet and can thereby exchange data over it. These devices are not just traditional computers, but include smart appliances and digital assistants for the home, or sensors and monitoring equipment needed by industries from manufacturing and distribution to healthcare.

Emerging sectors ranked by number of active high-growth UK Future Living companies (2021)

EdTech	394
eHealth	425
Internet of Things	387
Artificial Intelligence	175
Gamification	74
Wearables	73
The "Quantified Self"	50
Big data	50
Digital security	45
Smart homes	43
Virtual reality	39
Augmented reality	26
Preventive care	21
Services on demand	19
Blockchain	18

Sustainability and Future Living companies

In 2019, the UK government passed legislation to end its contribution to global warming by 2050, meaning greenhouse gas emissions must become net zero. The road to net zero emissions will be paved by entrepreneurial innovation, and indeed many of the companies underpinning this report are working on technologies to support this mission.

Though vitally important, clean energy firms are not the only companies addressing climate change. High-growth Future Living startups are changing the way we eat, learn and live. EdTech, a sector which has grown hugely during the pandemic, is key for greener schools and universities. Not only does it make paperless learning possible, EdTech supports hybrid learning that massively cuts travel and campus emissions. Similarly, the eHealth industry reduces the energy consumption of information technology within healthcare, as well as can support the production of more eco-friendly medical devices.

The rise of the Internet of Things perhaps has one of the most significant roles to play. The World Economic Forum notes Internet of Things projects will be a key focus to meet the UN's 2030 Sustainable Development Agenda, adopted by 194 countries. These devices can perform analytics in real time on issues such as energy efficiency and water use.

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Future Living companies

eHealth firms are well represented among the Future Living companies. Video consultation app Babylon has raised more equity investment than any other digital health company for a total of £51.8m. It reached unicorn status in 2019 and listed on the NYSE via a SPAC in October 2021. Another eHealth startup that has been successful at raising capital is Cera, which allows users to book

carers online. It has secured £75m in equity investment.

By Many brings a data-driven and digital approach to pet insurance.

Outside of healthcare, Future Living companies are creating innovative technology to improve customers' lives. Internet of Things business Elvie offers wearables for women such as an electric breast pump and a pelvic floor trainer. Insuretech unicorn Bought

Another unicorn, SumUp, provides a payment processing system for small businesses. The scaleup has secured £95.1m of equity and debt.



About the authors



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FREYA HYDE

Freya performs data analysis and visualisation in the Research and Consultancy team. She has worked on projects for Barclays, EY and JP Morgan. She holds a BA in History (International) from the University of Leeds, which included a year at Fudan University in Shanghai, and is currently learning Python for data science.

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ALICE WILLIAMS

Alice executes statistical analysis and data visualisation for the Research and Consultancy team. Prior to joining Beauhurst, Alice read Law at Durham University, where she acquired an undergraduate degree (LLB) and a Masters of Jurisprudence.

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